

Sixth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Sexta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: the baptized are buried, fed, steadied, and fortified

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Dominus fortitudo plebis suae</i> (Ps. 27:8–9)	Strength for God's people	God enters as strength and saving protector of a people whom he blesses and rules.
Collect	<i>Deus virtutum</i> : increase religion; nourish and guard the good	Growth in grace	The new life requires God both to implant love of his name and preserve what grace begins.
Epistle	Rom. 6:3–11	Buried with Christ; newness of life	Baptism gives participation in Christ's death and resurrection, not advice for renovating the old man.
Gradual	<i>Convertere, Domine; Domine, refugium factus es nobis</i> (Ps. 89:13, 1)	The Lord's return and refuge	The newly alive answer the Epistle by asking the Lord to return and by confessing him as their refuge.
Alleluia	<i>In te, Domine, speravi</i> (Ps. 30:2–3)	Trust and deliverance	Trust in God's inclined ear prepares the assembly to hear why Christ will not send the hungry away fasting.
Gospel	Mark 8:1–9	Christ feeds the four thousand	Christ's compassion supplies a people who cannot sustain themselves on the way.
Offertory	<i>Perfice gressus meos</i> (Ps. 16:5–7)	Steady steps in God's paths	The baptized life becomes an offered walk whose steps still require divine keeping.
Communion	<i>Circumibo et immolabo</i> (Ps. 26:6)	Sacrifice of jubilation	At the altar, received mercy returns to God as praise and jubilant sacrifice.
Postcommunion	<i>Repleti sumus, Domine, muneribus tuis</i>	Cleansing and aid	God's gifts are asked to cleanse by their effect and fortify by their help.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Romans 6 says that the baptized have been buried with Christ and must reckon themselves dead to sin; Mark 8 recounts Christ's compassionate feeding of a hungry multitude.
Allegorical	Baptism joins the Church to Christ's paschal death and life. Augustine reads the loaves as scriptural and spiritual nourishment; in the wider canonical and liturgical tradition, the multiplication also prefigures the superabundance of the Eucharist.
Moral	The Christian must refuse the old servitude, walk in the grace already given, confess dependence, and receive rather than pretend to be self-sustaining.
Anagogical	Christ keeps his pilgrim people from failing on the road and directs them toward the final feast, where resurrection life is no longer threatened by sin, hunger, or death.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Grave and Mother	Cyril's <i>Mystagogical Catechesis II</i> reads the baptismal water as both grave and mother: sacramental dying and birth occur together because Christ's real death and resurrection bestow real salvation.
Walk and Steps	Paul's "newness of life" becomes the Offertory's petition for steady steps. Editorially, the pairing shows that baptismal identity must take bodily form in habits and choices, while every step remains dependent upon grace.
Bread	Augustine's <i>Sermon 45</i> treats the breaking of bread as the exposition of Scripture and the seven loaves as the sevenfold work of the Spirit. That documented doctrinal reading is distinct from, but compatible with, the Church's canonical Eucharistic application of the multiplication.
Seven Baskets	Augustine reads seven as perfection and the baskets as the Church receiving fragments that are not lost. Abundance therefore names not vague optimism but the Spirit's provision for the whole ecclesial body.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

The Mass does not merely place baptism beside bread. It moves a people strengthened by God through burial with Christ, confessed dependence, offered perseverance, received gift, cleansing, and aid.

Thread	Synthesis
Introit — entrance	<i>Dominus fortitudo plebis suae</i> (Ps. 27:8–9) gives the corporate starting point: the Lord saves, blesses, and rules his inheritance. Editorially, Romans will describe the sacramental making of this people.
Collect — petition	<i>Deus virtutum</i> asks for love of God's name, increase of religion, nourishment of the good, and protection of what has been nourished. Grace must initiate, mature, and guard the life proclaimed next.

Thread	Synthesis
Epistle — apostolic diagnosis	Romans 6:3–11 announces death to sin and new life in Christ. Cyril, <i>Mystagogical Catechesis II</i> , 4–7, reads descent and ascent in the font as participation by likeness in Christ’s burial and resurrection, with salvation given in reality.
Gradual — chanted response	<i>Convertere, Domine</i> and <i>Domine, refugium factus es nobis</i> (Ps. 89:13, 1) answer the Epistle with a plea for the Lord’s return and a confession of refuge. Editorially, the newly alive do not leave dependence behind.
Alleluia — preparation	<i>In te, Domine, speravi</i> (Ps. 30:2–3) asks deliverance and God’s swiftly inclined ear. Trust prepares the assembly to hear why Christ will not send the hungry away fasting.
Gospel — disclosure	Mark 8:1–9 reveals divine compassion acting through blessing, breaking, distribution, and abundance. Augustine, <i>Sermon 45</i> , 1–2, reads this as the bread of Scripture, the sevenfold Spirit, and the Church; Eucharistic prefiguration is a separate canonical and liturgical application, not attributed here to that sermon.
Offertory — self-offering	<i>Perfice gressus meos</i> (Ps. 16:5–7) offers the baptized person’s still-unstable walk. The indicative of burial and rising becomes a petition that actual steps remain in God’s paths.
Secret — offered petition	The Secret asks God to receive the people’s offerings so that no vow be fruitless and faithful petition attain its effect. The altar exposes the fantasy that resolve alone can complete the new life.
Communion — sacramental reception	<i>Circumibo et immolabo hostiam iubilationis</i> (Ps. 26:6) names jubilant sacrifice. In its Communion placement, the editorial liturgical connection is that those sustained by gift return praise around God’s altar.
Postcommunion — continuing effect	<i>Repleti sumus</i> asks that the gifts already received cleanse and fortify. The Mass ends not in self-congratulation but in a plea that sacramental grace continue its work.

Grouped instruction (editorial synthesis). God does not improve an autonomous old life: he buries and raises a people in Christ, hears their need, feeds them by word and sacrament, steadies their offered steps, and makes his gifts effective as cleansing and strength.

Exegetical Notes

- Paul gives the sacramental indicative before the moral imperative: those who have died with Christ are then commanded to reckon themselves dead to sin.
- Mark’s three days and Cyril’s threefold baptismal descent permit a paschal comparison, but that comparison is an editorial synthesis rather than an interpretation claimed from Augustine’s *Sermon 45*.
- The Secret prevents “newness of life” from becoming voluntarism: faithful desire itself asks God for efficacious completion.

Patristic and Sainly Witnesses

Witness	Text / source status	Homiletic use
St. Cyril of Jerusalem	Paraphrase — <i>Mystagogical Catechesis II</i> , 4–7: the font represents Christ’s burial and resurrection; the likeness communicates real salvation.	Preach baptism as gift and participation: the old man is not cosmetically improved but carried into Christ’s paschal passage.

Witness	Text / source status	Homiletic use
St. Augustine	Paraphrase — <i>Sermon 45 on the New Testament</i> , 1–2: scriptural exposition breaks bread; the seven loaves signify the Spirit’s sevenfold work and the four thousand the Church.	Let Augustine govern the doctrinal sense of bread, while clearly identifying the Eucharistic reading as a distinct canonical application.

Homiletic Synthesis

Thread	Synthesis
Proposition	The life given in baptism can be lived only as a continually received gift: Christ buries the old man, feeds the new, steadies his steps, and fortifies him for the road.
Movement I — gift	God makes a people his inheritance, joins them to Christ’s death and resurrection, and refuses to dismiss their hunger unattended.
Movement II — resistance	The old servitude survives as the illusion that baptism is merely past, resolve is self-sufficient, or need is evidence of abandonment.
Movement III — sacramental conversion	At the Offertory unstable steps and petitions are given to God; in Communion his gift is received as praise, cleansing, and aid rather than earned as a reward.
Final horizon	Treat one concrete sin as belonging to the buried old man, take the next faithful step by grace, and receive Christ’s provision as a pledge of resurrection and the final feast.

Preaching Applications

- Name one form of the old servitude that must be reckoned dead rather than negotiated with.
- Present Sunday Mass as provision for weak pilgrims, not a prize for those who already feel strong.
- Join baptismal identity to one repeatable “step”: confession, restitution, a guarded habit, or a duty accepted in charity.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Sexta post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus, Introit through Postcommunion. Latin OCR remains subject to printed-missal verification.
- St. Cyril of Jerusalem, *Mystagogical Catechesis II* (Catechetical Lecture 20), 4–7; trans. Edwin Hamilton Gifford, NPNF 2.7 (1894), [working public-domain text](#).
- St. Augustine, *Sermon 45 on the New Testament*, 1–2, on Mark 8:5; trans. R. G. MacMullen, NPNF 1.6 (1888), [working public-domain text](#).
- *Catechism of the Catholic Church*, 1335, on the multiplication of loaves as Eucharistic prefiguration, [official English text](#).

Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. Cyril of Jerusalem, *Mystagogical Catechesis II*, 4: “And at the self-same moment you were both dying and being born; and that Water of salvation was at once your grave and your mother.”
- St. Augustine, *Sermon 45 on the New Testament*, 1: “In expounding to you the Holy Scriptures, I as it were break bread for you.”